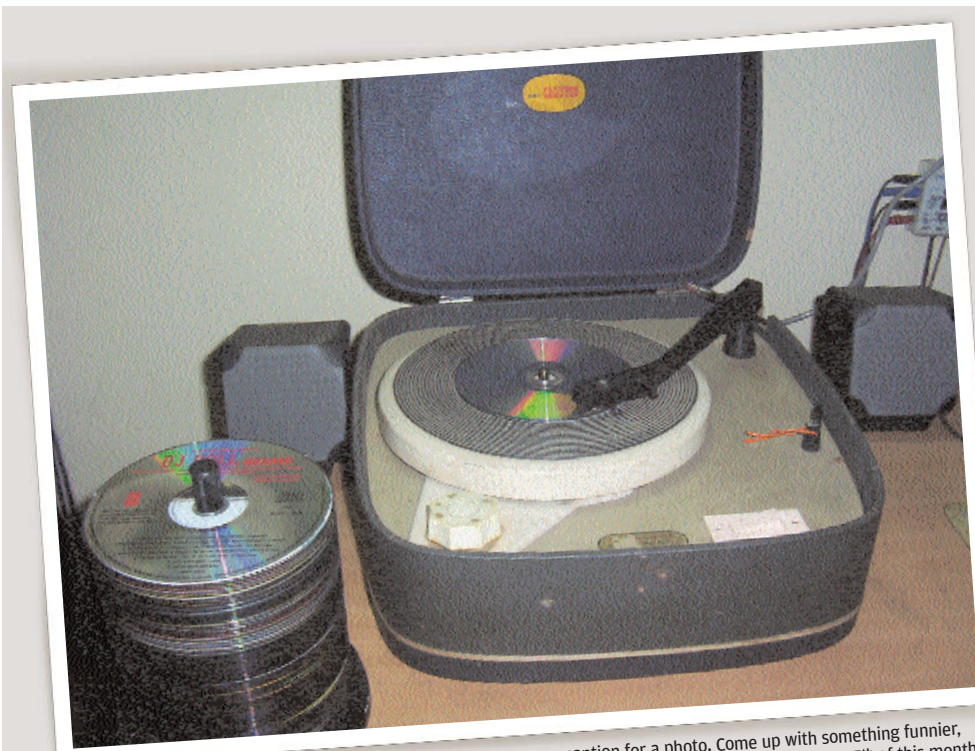




Photograph Abhijit Roy, Kolkata

Each month, *Digit* will carry a caption for a photo. Come up with something funnier, and beat the *Digit* team at their own game! Entries accepted by the 15th of this month.

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name "Live". As one example, MSN Messenger will now become Windows Live Messenger. MSN will be "split" into MSN and Windows Live, though we don't know exactly how the split will be implemented.

Microsoft is heavily touting Live as a foray into offering software and services over the Internet. Analysts say it's a way to

better compete with Google, Yahoo! and others.

With the original MSN portal being stripped down, John Nicol, the executive recently put in charge of MSN, said the changes will allow MSN to focus more on providing content such as entertainment and home videos. Nicol said the revamped MSN will include more opportunities for users to contribute their own

content, such as posting their own videos or rating hotels on MSN's travel site.

A major focus will be on providing more video content, aiming to go beyond re-broadcasting television.

But there are the doubters. Matt Rosoff, analyst with independent researchers Directions on Microsoft, said he's still waiting to see what Microsoft plans to devote to the new MSN, especially since the

company is so heavily focused on the Live effort. "Until I actually start seeing new products, or even updates to the existing ones, I'll remain sceptical that it's really a focus for the company," he said.

REWRITING HISTORY

Character Revamping At Wikipedia

There seems to be a Wikipedia controversy every month or so now: the online reference site has accused US Congress staff of changes to several political biographies, changes that portrayed the politicians in a more positive light. Computers traced to Capitol Hill had removed "unpalatable" facts from articles on senators, while other entries were "vandalised," Wikipedia said. An inquiry was launched after staff for Democratic representative Marty Meehan admitted to having spruced up his biography.

The site lists six prominent biographies that had been changed by Senate computers.

One senator's office has confirmed that his staff made a number of changes to his online record: where Mr Coleman was described as a "liberal" back in college, it was changed to "activist." Senator Coleman's chief of staff, Erich Mische, said editing was done to correct inaccuracies and delete information that was not reflective of the politician. "They've got an edit provision on there for the sake of editing when things are not accurate," Mr Mische told the Associated Press. "I presume that if they did not want people to edit, they wouldn't allow you to edit."

Wikipedia says the controversy raises questions about whether it is ethical for those with a vested interest in the subject to edit entries about it. It said the Congressional computer network has been blocked from editing for brief periods on a number of

